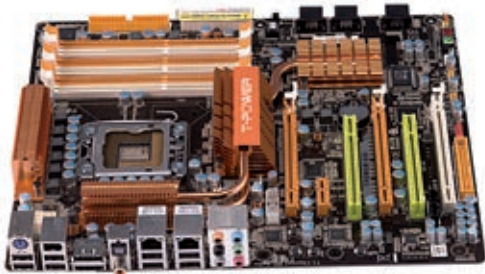


Motherboards

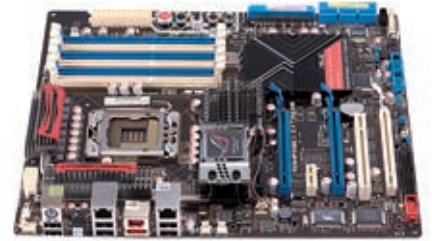
Motherboards are the base of any system. Compromising on a motherboard almost always results in problems of varied sorts. No matter what platform you go for, you should always go in for the best that you can afford. There's something for everyone here.



Intel motherboards Biostar Tpower X58

In case of Intel, the fastest platform we have is LGA1366 that plays home for the top of the line Core i7 processors.

The benchmarks that we've run also prove that it's the fastest platform for Intel's platform. The only chipset so far is Intel's X58. Even in this short time span, there have been many boards spawned by every motherboard manufacturer there is. Biostar is a brand that has only recently become popular. Sales are improving by the looks of things. Their latest product the Tpower X58 was one of the cheapest X58 motherboards that came to the test. The cheapest one was the MSI X58M which was a micro ATX board. The Biostar Tpower X58 was a little more expensive at Rs. 12,500 but had some more features and it was designed very well.



Best Performer (Intel platform) ASUS Rampage 2 Extreme

The top performer of the category for Intel processors was from ASUS. The Rampage II Extreme was one of the best boards around. It belongs to the enthusiast class of boards from ASUS called Republic of Gamers. The board was priced at Rs. 28,500 a couple of months back.



Best Performer (AMD platform) ASUS M4A79T



AMD motherboards Jetway HA07 Ultra

There is no shortage of boards for the AMD platform either. The Best Buy award goes to the Jetway HA07 Ultra which runs on the AMD 790FX chipset. It's a full fledged board that doesn't look too fancy by the looks of things. We had a few complaints about the quality of the heatsink as well but that's about it. It's got all the features you need and features that match boards close to three times its cost. This enthusiast class board sells for Rs. 5,500. Performance isn't a major problem with motherboards. You find a difference of just a couple of per cent between boards using a common chipset.

If you aren't willing to settle with average quality and want the best of all worlds, you have to be willing to go in for the ASUS M4A79T board. It too is based on the AMD 790FX chipset. It's got an excellent layout and most importantly, a very flexible BIOS that's very overclocker friendly.